



OF

SCOTS PROVERBS,

CONSISTING OF THE

Wise Sayings and Observations
OF THE
OLD PEOPLE OF SCOTLAND.

BY ALLAN RAMSAY,

THE SCOTS POET.

VOX POPULI VOX DEI.

That maun be true that a' Men say.

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A Begun turn is ha'f ended

A A blate cat makes a proud mouse

A black hen lays a white egg

A blythe heart makes a blooming look

5 Abundance of law breaks nae law

A hungry stomach is aye craving

A cock's aye crouse on his ain midding

A dog winna yowl if ye fell him wi' a baac

A dog's life, meikle ease meikle hunger

10 A drink is shorter than a tale

A dry simmer ne'er made a dear peck

A dumb man wins nae law

A bird in the hand is worth ten fleein'

Ae good turn deserves anither

15 Ae ha'f o' the world kenna how the other ha'f live

Ae hand winna wash the ither for nought

Ae hour's cauld will suck out seven year's heat

Ae swallow makes nae simmer

Ae scabbed sheep will smit the hale hirdsel

20 A fool may gie a wise man a counsel

A friend in need is a friend indeed

Ast counting keeps friends lang the gither

Ast times the cautioner pays the debt

A fou purse never laces friends

25 A gi'en horse shou'd na be look'd in the mouth

A good now may hae an ill ca'f

A good word is as soon said as an ill

A good tale is no the war to be twice told

A good name is sooner rint than won

30 A good fellow is a costly name

A handfu' of trade is worth a gowpen of gowd

A hungry man smells meat far

A hungry dole bites fair

A hungry man's aye angry

35 A laze that has many wooers aft wails the warst

Ale sellers shou'd na be tale tellers

A far should ha'e a good memory

A light purse makes a heavy heart

A' the coar's no shame by bempers

- 40 A' no tat that's in hazard
 A' Stewards are no sib to the king
 A's well that ends well
 A' things are good untry'd
 A man canna bear a' his kin on his back
- 45 A man at five may be a fool at fifteen
 A man may be kind and gie little o' his gear
 A man's well or wae, as he thinks himsel' sae,
 A man has nae mair goods than he gets good of
 A misty morning may be a clear day
- 50 A mouthfu' of meat may be a townfu' of shame
 A muffled cat was ne'er a good hunter
 An auld mason makes a good barrow-man
 An auld sack craves muckle clouting
 An auld pock is aye skelling
- 55 An old dog bites ficker
 An ill shearer never gat a good hook
 An ill cow may have a good ca'st
 An ill plea should be well pled
 An ill turn is soon done
- 60 An ill servant ne'er prov'd a good master
 Ane never tines by doing good
 Anes paid never grav'd
 Anes a whore and aye a whore
 Ane may bind a sack before it be fu'
- 65 Ane is no sae soon heal'd as hurt
 Ane gets sma' thanks for tining his ain
 Ane will gar a thousand lie
 A new besom sweeps clean
 A nod of an honest man is enough
- 70 A pound of care winna pay an ounce of debt
 A ragged colt may prove a good gelding
 A rowing stane gathers nae fog
 As broken a ship has come to land
 As brisk as bottled ale
- 75 As lang lives the merry man as the sad
 As ready as the king has an egg in his pouch
 As fair fight wrens as cranes
 As tired as a tike is of lang kail
 As the sow fills the draff sours
- 80 As the auld cock craws the young one learns
 As the fool thinks the bell clinks

- As ye mak your bed sae ye maun ly down
 A fillerless man gangs fast through the markit
 A sorrowfu' heart's aye dry
 85 At open doors dogs gae ban
 A tarrowing bairn's was never fat
 A taking hand will never want
 A tale never times in the telling
 A tocherless dame sits lang at hame
 90 A toom purse makes a prattling merchant
 A toom pantry makes a thriftless gudewife
 A turn well done is soon done
 A twapenny cat may look at the king
 A wee bush is better than nae bield
 95 A wee mouse can creep under a great corn stack
 A wee house has a wide mouth
 A wee thing fleys cowards
 A wilfu' man should be unco wise
 Auld men are twice bairns
 100 Auld sparrows are ill to tame
 Auld springs gie wee price
 A yeld sow was never good to grices

B

- B** Are gentry braggand beggars
 Be a friend to yoursel and others will
 105 Be lang sick that ye may be soon hale
 Bear wealth well: poortith will bear itsel
 Be guess as the blind man fell'd the dog
 Beggars shoudna be choosers
 Better a bit in the morning than fast a' day
 110 Better a deil than a daw
 Better a dog fawn on you than bark at you
 Better a finger aff than aye wagging
 Better an auld maiden than a young whore
 Better a toom house than an ill tenant
 115 Better auld debts than auld sairs
 Better to be envied than pitied
 Better to be alane than in ill company
 Better be idle than ill employed
 Better belly burst than good meat spill
 120 Better buy than barrow
 Better day the better de-d
 Better sand iron than time

- Better hand by a hair than draw wi'out bad makers
 Better hand loose than in an ill tethering
 125 Better kiss a knave than cast out wi' him
 Better keep well than make well
 Better lang something than soon naething
 Better leave to my faes, than beg frae my friends
 Better rue fit than rue slit
 130 Better sit idle than work for nought
 Better skaith fav'd than mends made
 Better sma' fish than nae fish
 Better the ill ken'd than the good unken'd
 Better to hand than draw
 135 Better unborn than untaught
 Better wait on the cook than the doctor
 Better wear shoon than nae
 Birds of ae feather flock together
 Birch's good but breeding's better
 140 Blind men should na judge of colours
 Blood's thicker than water
 Burnt bairns the fire dreads

C

- CAdgers have aye mind of lade saddles
 Cast a bane in a deil's teeth
 145 Charity begins at hame
 Come unca'd sit, unserved
 Comes to my hand like the bowl of a pint stoup
 Come wi' the wind and gae with the water
 Confess debt and crave days
 150 Corn him well he'll work the better
 Count again is not forbidde
 Count filler after a your kin
 Count like Jews and gree like brethren
 Counsel is nae command
 155 Credit keeps the crown of the causey
 Credit is better than ill luck
 Crooked carlin, quoth the carle to his wife
 Cur your cloak according to the clath

D

DAming and laving is good sure fishing
 Daughters and dead fish are nae keeping
 Dawted bairns do bear little

As ye mak

Day light will peep through a sma' hole
Death and marriage make term day
Death defies the doctors

165 Delays are dangerous

Do well and dread nae shame

Do well and have well

Do what you ought and come what will

Do the likeliest and hope the best

170 Do as the lassies do, say no, and take it

Double drinks are good for drouth

Double charges rive cannons

Drass's good enough for swine

Drink little that ye may drink lang

175 Dree out the inch when ye have thole'd the least

E

E Agles catch nae flies

Eat well's drink well's brother

Eating and drinking wants but a beginning

Either live or die with honour

180 Evening oats are good morning fother

Enough's as good as a feast

Every ane creeshes the fat sow's arse

Every one kens best where his ain shoe nips him

Every crow thinks its a bird whitest

185 Every dog has his day

Every man wears his belt his ain gait

Every man's tale is good till anither's be tauld

Every man has his ain drass pock

Every thing has an end, and a pudding has two

190 Experience teaches fools

F

F Aint-heart never won a fair lady

Fair heights make fools faine

Fair words winna gar the pot play

Fair hair may have foul roots

195 Fancy kills and cures

Fancy flees before the wind

Far away fowls have fair feathers

Far behind that may na follow

Feckless fouk are aye fain of ane anither

200 Fiddlers dogs, and flesh flies, come to feast: unca'd

Fine feathers make fine birds

- Fire and water are good servants but bad masters
 Flaes and a gipping wife are wakerife bed fellows
 Flying a bird is not the gate to grip it
 05 Fools shou'd na ha'e chapping sticks
 Fools make feasts and wise men eat them
 The wise make jests, and fools repeat them
 For fashion's sake as dogs gang to the market
 Forbid a tool a thing and that he will do
 10 Forewarn'd ha'f armed
 Foul water slockens fire
 Friendship canna stand aye on ae side
 Fresh fish and poor friends grow soon ill far'd
 Frost and fashood have baith a dirty wa'gang
 G
- 215 **G**ear is easier gain'd than guided
 Gentle paddocks have long tae's
 Giff gaff makes good friends
 Give a dog an ill name and he'll soon be hang'd
 Give a man luck and fling him in the sea
 220 Give o'er when the play's good
 Give them tow enough and they'll hang themselves
 Give you an inch you'll take an ell
 (lasses and lasses are bruckle ware
 Good ale needs nae wisp
 225 Good hair get broken brows
 Good fouk are scarce, take care of me
 Good watch prevents harm
 Good ware make a quick market
 230 Gowd may be dear cost
 Great barkers are nae biters
 Greedy fouk have lang arms
 Gut nae fish till ye get them
 H
- 235 **H**aud a hank in your ain hand
 Hae gars a deaf man hear
 Hair and hair make the earle's beard bare
 Hame is hame if it were never sae hamely
 Hand in use is rather of lair
 Handle the pudding while it is het
 240 Hang hunger and drown drouth
 Had and a halfpenny is gear enough
 Have ye gear have ye name, fine heart and a's gane

- He brings a staff to break his ain head
He comes aftner with the rake than the shool
245 He complains early that complains of his kail
He cares na whase bairn greet if his laugh
He can say Jo and think it no
He can hide his meat and seek mair
He can see an inch before his nose
250 He does na aye ride when he saddles his horse
He sells twa dogs wi ae flane
He gat his kail in a riven dish
He has gotten the boot and the better beast
He has mickle prayer but little devotion
255 He has come to good by misguiding
He has an eye in his neck
He has a bee in his bonnet lug
He has gotten a bite of his ain bridle
He has the best end of the string
260 He has't of kind, he coft it not
He has feather'd his nest, he may flee when he like
He has cowped the mickle dish into the little
He has gotten the whip hand of him
He has licket the butter aff my bread
265 He has a crap for a' corn
He kens na a B by a bull's foot
He kens whilk side his cake is bttuered on
He'll no let grass grow at his heels
He'll gie you the whistle of your groat
270 He'll tell't to mae mair than he meets
He'll make an ill runner that canna gang
He'll wag as the bush wags
He'll soon be a beggar that canna say nae
He may well swim that has his head-hadden up
275 He maun be soon up that cheats the tod
He made a moon-light flitting
He may find faut that canna mend
He may laugh that winna
He never lies but when the Holin's green
280 He rides sicker that never fa's
He's a fool that forgets himsel
He's gane to the dog-drave
He's horn deaf on that side of the head
He's auld, and cauld, and ill to lie beside

- 5 He's wife that's timely way
 He's as welcome as water in a riven ship
 He's an Aberdeen man, takes his word again
 He's no fae daft as he let's on
 He's fairest dung that's paid with his ain wand
 10 He's a proud fox that winna scrape his ain hole
 He's a hawk of a right nest
 He's a filly chief that can neither do nor say
 He's the gear that winna traik
 He's well wordy sorrow that buys it
 15 He's like the finged cat, better than he's likely
 He sleeps as dogs do when wives sift meal
 He that blaws best let him beat the horn
 He that cheats me aces, shame fa' him;
 If he cheat me twice, shame fa' me
 He that clatters to himself talks to a fool
 20 He that canna mak sport shou'd mar name
 He that does you an ill turn will ne'er forgie you
 He that deals in dirt has aye foul fingers
 He that gets forgets, but he that wants thinks on't
 He that has a good crop may thole some thistles
 25 He that has meikle wad aye hae mair
 He that has but ae eye maun tent that well
 He that nas a muckle nole thinks ilk ane speaks o't
 He that's ill to himself will be good to naeboddy
 He that lends his por may see the his kail in his loof
 30 He laughs at his ain sport spills the sport o't
 He that lippens to bodden ploughs, his land lies lee
 He that lives upon hope has a slim diet
 He that looks to freets, freets follow him
 He that shaws his purse bribes the thief
 35 He that sleeps with dogs maun rise with flaes
 He that sits on a stane is twice fain
 He that seeks motes get motes
 He that speers all opinions comes ill speed
 He that teaches himself has a fool for his master
 40 He that winns when he may, shanna when he wad
 He that wad eat the kirnal maun crack the nut
 He that winna thole maun sit mony a hole
 He was the bee that made the honey
 He wad gang a mile to flit a fow
 45 He winna send you away with a fair heart
 He wat's nae whilk oad o' him's appertmed

He woads me for cake and pudding
He wad fain be forward, if he wist how
He wad gar you trow that the moon is made of green
cheese

330 Hens are aye free of horse corn
His auld brags will buy a new pan
His bark is waur than his bite
His heart's in his hose
His room's better than his company

335 His tongue's nae slander
His tongue's no in his pouch
Hooly and fair game a far in a day
Hunger is good kitchen
Hungry dogs are lying of bursten puddings

340 Hungry stewards wear mony shoon

II Bake nae bread by your shine

I I can scarce believe you, ye speak fae fair

I canna afford you both tale and lugs

I have gien a stick to break my ain head

345 I have another tow on my rock

I have mair ado than a dish to wash

I have tane the sheaf frae the mare

I have bath my meat and my mense

I have seen mair than I have eaten

350 I ken by my cog who milks my cow

I'll gie you a meeting as Mungo gae his mither

I'll gar his ain garters tye up his ain hose

I'll gar him draw his belt to his ribs

I'll never dirty the bonnet I'm going to put on

355 I'll never lout sae laigh and lift sae little

I like not to make a toil of pleasure

I'm o'er auld a cat to draw a frae before

I'm no every man's dog that whistles on me

I'm no obliged to summer and winter it to you

360 I might bring a better speaker frae hame than you

I may come to break an egg in your pouch

I never lik'd a dry bargain

I never bl'd 'bout gates, quoth the wife, when she

harl'd her man o'er the ingle

I never lo'd meat that crawled in my craigie

I think mair of your kindness than it's a' worth

I wadna father you for your mack

I wadna ca' the king my coulin
 I wad rather see't than hear tell o' it
 I winna make fish of ane and flesh of another
 0 I wish you readier meat than a running hare
 I wish you as sauckle good o't as dogs get o' grafs
 If any speir at ye, ge may say, ye dinna ken
 If and and spills mony a good charter
 If e'er I find his cart tumbling, I'll gie a put
 5 If he make even a good pudding, I'll eat the prick
 If it canna kep geese I'll kep gairlins
 If I canna do't by might I'll do't by flight
 If I live anither year, I'll eat this year fernyear
 If it can be nae better, it is well it is na war
 10 If it serves me to wear it may gain you to look to
 If it winna fells it winna sour
 If straits be good to gie, they'll be good to get
 If ye brew well, ye'll drink the better
 If ye do wrang, make amends
 15 If ye serve the tod, ye maun bear up his tail
 Ill bairns are best heard at hame
 Ill beef never made good broo
 Ill comes upon the war's back
 Ill counsel will gar a man stick his mare
 20 Ill doers are aye ill dreaded
 Ill getting het water frae 'neath cauld ice
 Ill hearing makes wrang rehearsing
 Ill laying up makes mony thieves
 Ill news are aye owre true
 25 Ill payers are aye good cravers
 Ill workers are aye good to-putters
 Ill will never make well
 Joke at leifure, ye kennä wha may jybe yoursell
 Jook and let the jaw gae o'er
 30 It came with the wind let it gang with the water
 It gangs in at the ae lug and out at the ither
 It is a good goose that draps aye
 It is a good game that fills the wame
 It is a good tongue that says nae ill
 35 It is an ill wind that blaws naebody good
 It is an ill cause that the lawyers think shame o'
 It is a wee mouse that has but ae hole
 It is a naeety bird that files its ain nest

- It is a poor kin that has neither whore nor thief in't
 410 It is the sign of a hale heart that rift at the rumple
 It is a fair field where a's slain
 It is a sooth dream that's seen waking
 It is a silly flock where the ewe bears the bell
 It is a silly hen that canna scrape for ae bird
 415 It is a tight tree that has neither knap nor gaw
 It is a' tint that is done to auld folk and bairns
 It is but kindly that the pock sa' of the herring
 It is better to sup with a cutty than want a spoon
 It is by the head that the cow gie's milk
 420 It is to come to mickle, but 'tis to come to that
 It is good maut that comes a will
 It is good gear that pleases the merchant
 It is good baking beside the meal
 It is good sleeping in a hale slein
 425 It is good to be out of harm's gate
 It is good to be sib to filler
 It is good to be good in your time, ye kenna how
 lang it may last
 It is hard to sit in Rome and strive with the Pope
 It is hard to please a' parties
 430 It is hard baith to have and want
 It is ill getting breeks off a bare arse
 It is ill bringing butt what's no benn
 It is kittle shooting at corbies and clergy
 It is kittle to waken sleeping dogs
 435 It is needliss to pour water on a drown'd mouse
 It is not tint that a friend gets
 It is not what is she, but what has she
 It is past jouking when the head's aff
 It is well war'd that wasters want
 540 It is well that our faults are not written on our face
 It is the best spake in your wheel
 It keeks his nose at the grindstane
 It will be a feather out of your wing
 It was never for naething that the gleg whistled

K

- 445 **K** EEP something for a fair foot
 Keep your ain fish guts to your ain sea-maws
 Keep your tongue within you teeth
 Keep the feast to the feast day

- Keep the staff in your ain hand
40 Keep your breath to cool your crowdie
Keep your mouth close and your een open
Kend fouk's nae company
Kings and bears aft worry their keepers
Kiss a selate stane and that winna slaver you
55 Kyth in your ain colours that fouk may ken you

L

- L** AITH to bed and laith to rise
Lang fasting hains nae meat
Lang look'd for comes at last
Lang fasting gathers wind
460 Lang straes are nae mots
Lang ere ye saddle a foal
Law's cotti take a pint and 'gree
Law makers shou'dna be law-breakers
Laugh at leisure ye may greet ere night
65 Lay the head of the fow to the tail of grice
Leave welcome behind ye
Leave aff as lang as the play's good
Learn you to an ill use and ye'll ca't custom
Letna the plough stand to slay a mouse
70 Let bell'd weather break the snaw
Let him take a spring on his ain fiddle
Let him cool in the skin he het in
Let his ain wand ding him
Let never sorrow come sae near your heart
75 Let the horns gang with the hide
Let the morn come and the meat wi't
Let the kirk stand in the kirkyard
Let them laugh that win
Let them ease that come behind
80 Lie for him and he'll swear for you
Light burdens break nae banes
Like Sotsmen, aye wise behind the hand
Like the cur in the crab, he'll neither do nor let do
Like's an ill mark
85 Like a fow playing on a trump
Like the wife, that never cried for the laddle, till
the pot ran o'er
Lippen to me but look to yourself
Little kend the less ear'd for

Little odds between a feat and fur' wame

490 Loud at the loan was ne'er a good milk cow

Love's as warm amang cotters as courtiers

Love your friend and look to yoursel

M

Maidens bairns are aye well bred

Mair by luck than good guiding

495 Mair haste the war speed, quoth the tailor to the
lang thread

Mair hamely than welcome

Make ae lang step and down ye gae

Make a kirk on a mill o't

Make the best of an ill bargain

500 Make your hay when the sun shines

Malice is aye mindfu'

May bees flee not at this time of the year

Meat feeds, and clath cleeds, but manners make the
man

Meat and mair hinders no man

505 Men are not to be met by inches

Mickle wad aye hae mair

Mickle mouth'd fouk have aye hap to their meat

Mickle may fa' between the cap and the tip

Money makes a man free ilka where

510 Mony hands make light wark

Mony masters, quoth the paddock to the barrow

Mony hounds may soon worry ae hare

Mony excuses that pishes the led

Mony a ane serves a thankless master

515 Mony wyte their wife for their ain thriftless life

Mony dogs die or ye fa' heir

Mony a ane's gear has hastened his hinder end

Mony aunts mony eems, mony kin and few friends

Mony good nights is laith away

520 Mony ways to kill a dog though ye dinna hang him

Mony cooks ne'er made good kail

Mony a ane speirs the gate they ken fu' well

Must is a kings word

My tongue is no beneath your belt

525 My son's my son aye till he get a wife, my daughter',
my daughter a' the days of her life

My market's made, ye may lick a whelp

- Nae fool to an' auld fool
 Nae friend to a friend in need
 Nae great loss but there's some sma' advantage
 0 Nae man has a tack of his life
 Nae man can thrive unless his wife let him
 Nae penny nae paternoster
 Nae sooner up than her heads in the ambry
 Nae safe wading in unco waters
 10 Nae wonder to see waiters wait
 Naething freer than a gift
 Naething is balder than a blind mare
 Naething to be done in haste but gripping of saes
 Naething to do but draw in your stool and sit down
 10 Nane but fools and kaves lay wagers
 Nane sae deil but he hopes to be better
 Nane can play the fool sae well as a wife man
 Narrow gather'd widely spent
 Near's my fark but nearer my shua
 45 Neck or naething, the king loes nae cripples
 Necessity has nae law
 Neither fish nor flesh nor goad red herring
 New lords have new laws
 Never do ill that good may come
 50 Never let on you, but laugh in your ain sleeve
 Never put a sword into a madman's hand
 Never put the plough before the owse
 Never quat certainty for hope
 Never lead your lips in other fouls kail
 55 Never seek a wife till ye ken what to do with her
 Never shaw me the meat but the man
 Never shaw your teeth unless you can bite
 Never tell your fae when your foot sleeps
 Nineteen nay says of a maiden are ha'f a grant
 60 Now's now, and yule's in winter

O'er mickle of ae thing is good for naething
 O'er mickle hamelines spills good courteay
 O'er mickle loose leather about your chafts
 O'er ficker o'er loose
 Of a' sorrow a fou sorrow's best
 Of a' meat in the world drink gae best down

- Of twa illa chause the least
 On painting and fighting look adreigh
 Open confession is good for ehe saul
 570 Out of debt out of danger
 Oppression will make a wise man mad
 Out of sight out of langour

P

- P**AY him in his ain coin
 Pith's good in a play
 575 Play's good while it is play
 Penny wise and pound fool
 Poor fouks friends soon misken
 Possession is eleven points of the law
 Pride and grace dwell never in ae place
 580 Provision in season makes a bein house
 Put the saddle on the right horse
 Put on your spurs and be at your speed

Q

- Q**uality without quantity is little thought of
 Quey cassas are dear yeal
 585 Quick for you'll never be cleanly
 Quick at meat quick at wark
 Quick returns make rich merchants

R

- R**ather spill your joke than tine your friend
 Raw dawds make fat lads
 590 Raw leather raxes
 Rich fouk have routh o' friends
 Ride fair and jap nane
 Right mixture makes good mortar
 Right wrangs nae man
 595 Rome was not bigged in ae day
 Roose the fair day at e'en
 Robin that herds on the height, can be as blythe
 as Sir Robert the knight
 Rob Peter to pay Paul
 Rot him away with butter and eggs
 600 Royet lads may make sober men
 Rue and time grew baith at ae garden
 Rule youth well, for auld will rule itself

SAIR cravers are aye ill payers
Say well and do well end with ae letter

- 605 Say well's good but do well is better
Say still no and ye'll never be married
Scant of cheeks makes a long nose
Scart the cogue wad sup mair
Scorn comes commonly with skaith
- 610 Seeing's believing a' the world o'er
Seeth stanes in butter the broo will be good
Send you to the sea, ye'll no get saut water
Serve yoursell till your bairns come to age
Set that down on the back side of your count-book
- 615 Set a knave to catch a knave
Set a stout heart to a stay brae
Sharp stomachs make short graces
Shoal waters make maist din
She is a wise wife that wather ain weird
- 620 She looks as if butter would not melt in her mou'
She hads up her head like a hen drinking water
She's not to be made a song of
She's better than she's bonny
Sic ye gie sic will ye get
- 625 Silence grips the mouse
Sic reck as is therein comes out of the lam
Slaw at meat slaw at wark
Smooth waters run deep
Sma' fish are better than nae fish
- 630 Soon enough if well enough
Sorrow is soon enough when it comes
Sorrow and ill weather come unsent for
Some hae hantle o' fauts ye're only a ne'er-do-well
Speak good of pipers your father was a fiddler
- 635 Spilt ale is waur than water
Stay and drink of your ain browst
Strike the iron as lang's its het
Stuffings hauds out storms
Stown dints are sweetest
- 640 Sudden friendship, sure repentance
Sup'd out wort was ne'er good ale
Surfeits slae mair than swords
Swear by your burnt shins
Sweet to bed and sweer up in the morning

- T
- 615 **T**ake it a' and pay the merchant
 Take the bit and buffet we't
 Take a pint and 'gree, the law's costly
 Take your ain will, and then ye'll no die of the pet
 Take your venture as mony a good ship has done
- 650 Take your thanks to feed your cat
 Take part of the pelf when the pack's a dealing
 Take a man by his word and a cow by her horn
 Take a hair of the dog that bit you
 Take me not up before I fa'
- 655 Tell nae tales out of the school
 That's a tale of twa drinks
 That's but a docter's opinion
 That's for the father but no for the son
 That's for that as butter's for fish
- 660 That's my tale where's your's
 That's the piece a step-bairn never got
 The auld iver may die waiting for new grafs
 The back and the belly hands every ane busy
 The better day the petter deed
- 665 The book of May Be's is very braid
 The banes of a great estate is worth the piking
 The cause is good, and the word Fa' on
 The cure may be worse than the disease
 The cow that's first up gets the first of the dew
- 670 The death of his first wife made sic a hole in his
 heart that a' the lave slip easily through
 The first suf of a fat haggis is the baldest
 The farther in the deeper
 The feathers bear away the flesh
 The grey mare may be the best horse
- 675 The greatest clerks are not the wisest men
 The happy man canna be herried
 The higher up the greater fa'
 The King's errand may come in the cadger's gate
 The langer we live we see the mae fairlies
- 680 The lazy man's the beggar's brother
 The lucky pennyworth sells soonest
 The langest day will have an end
 The laird may be laird and need his bind's help
 The mair ye greet ye'll pish the less
- 690 The mae the merrier, the fewer the better cheer

- The mair coo the mair honour
 The mawt is aboon the meal wi' him
 The mair noble the mair humble
 The master's ey makes the horse fat
 0 The mair mischief the better spout
 The pains o' ergangs the profit
 The poor man's aye put to the warst
 The poor man pays for a
 The poor man's shilling is b-- a penny
 5 The strongest horse louns the dike
 The scholar may war the master
 The still sow eats up a' the draff
 The smith has aye a spark in his hase
 The simple man's the beggar's brother
 10 The thief like the better foger
 The thing that's done is no to do
 The thing that's fristed is not forgien
 The tod keeps aye his ain hole clean
 The tod's whelps are ill to tame
 15 The tod never fares better than when he's bann'd
 The warst world that ever was some man wan
 The worth o' a thing is best kend by the want o't
 The world is bound to nae man
 The ussly fish gets the unlucky bait
 20 There is mony a true tale tell'd in a jest
 There is a measure in a' things
 There is nane sae blind as them that winna see
 There is naething ill said that's no ill tane
 There was never a fair word in flyting
 25 There was a wife that kept her supper for her
 breakfast, and she was dead or day
 There was never a cake but it had its mark
 There was never enough where naething was left
 There is skill in gruel making
 There is a time to gley and a time to look even
 30 There is a great differ among market days
 There is an end of an auld sang
 There is aye life for a living man
 There is an act in the laird of Grant's court, that no
 aboon e even speak at anes
 There is mae ways to the wood than ane
 35 There is mae married than good h' use hadders
 There never came ill after good advertisement

- There is fey blood in your bed
 There grows nae grass at the cross
 There is life in a mussel as lang as she cheeps
 730 There is little for the rake after the shool
 There is little to sew when tailors are true
 They are aye good that are far awa
 They are not a' saints that get holy water
 They complain early that complain of their kail
 735 They lo'e me for little that hate me for nought
 They mense little the mouth that bite aff the nose
 They that give you hinder you to buy
 They that burns you for a witch lose a' their coals
 They that drink langest live langest
 740 They that lie down for love should rise for hunger
 They were scant of bairns that brooght you up
 They wist as well that didna spair
 They that bourd wi' cats maun count upon scarta
 They are eith hindered that are not fundensome
 745 Thistles are a fallad for asses
 Thole well is good for burning
 Till ither, tinklers, ill may ye 'gree
 Time tint is ne'er to be found
 Three can keep a secret if twa be away
 750 Time and thinking tame the strongest grief
 Time and tide will tarry for no man
 Tine heart and a's gane
 Tine thimble tine thrift
 Touch a gawd horse on the back and he'll fling
 755 True blue will never stain
 Truth and honesty keep the crown of the causey
 Try your friend ever ye need him
 Two hungry meals make the third a glutton
 Two fools in ae house are a couple o'er mony
 760 Twa words maun gang to that bargain
 Twa wits are better than nane

W

- WANT of wit is waur than want of wealth
 Wealth in the widow's house; kail but faut
 Weans maan creep ere they gang
 765 Welcome is the best dish in the kitchen
 Well, quoth Willie, when his wife dang him
 Well is that well does

- Were it not for hope, heart wad break
 We'll never ken the worth o' water till the well gae dry
 70 We are aye to lear as lang as we live
 We can poid for debt, but no for unkindness
 We can shape their wylie coat, but no their weird
 We'll never big landy bourocks together
 We'll bark ourfells ere we buy dogs sae dear
 75 We canna baith sup and blaw
 We maun live by the living and no by the dead
 We are bound to be honest and no to be tech
 Who invited you to the roast
 Wha can haud what will awa'
 780 Wha dare bell the cat
 Wha can help misluck
 • Wha comes attener and brings less
 What we first lear we best ken
 What the eye sees na the heart ruefna
 785 What ye win at, that ye may lick aff a het girdle
 What carlins hain cats eat
 What winna do by might do by slight
 What's my ease the day may be yours the morn
 What's war than ill luck
 790 What need a rich man be a thief
 What canna be cured maun be endured
 When ae door steeks anither ane opens
 When a' men's speak nae man hears
 When drink's in wit's out
 795 When friends meet hearts warm
 When my head's down my house is theeked
 When the cow's in the clout she's soon out
 When the tod preaches take tent of the lamb
 When the wame's fu' the banes would be at rest
 800 When poverty comes in at the door friendship flies
 out at the winnock
 When a' treet's fail, fire's good for the scarcity
 When a cwe's drown'd she's dead
 When you are serv'd a' the geese are water'd
 When wine sinks words swim
 805 When ye're gawn and coming the gate's no toom
 When he dies for age ye may quack for fear
 When ye are well had yoursel sae
 When the well's fa' it will pu' owse

- When the steed's stown back the stable door
 810 Where the buck's bound there he mair bleat
 Where the pig's broken let the sherds lie.
 Where drums beat laws are dumb
 Wee things lie cowards
 Willful waste mak waeifu want
 815 Wiles help weak folk
 Will a fool's feather in my cap gat my plot play
 Will a wit strive with me
 Water thunder bodes summer hungry
 Wink at wee faults, your ain are muckle
 820 Wise men may be wile'd with wiles
 Wit bought makes fowk wise
 Wit bought is worth twa for nought
 Under water dearth, under snaw broad
 Work for nought makes fowk dread twear
 825 Woo-sellers ken aye woo-buyers
 He makes perfyttness
 Wrang has nae warrant
 Wrang count is nae payment

Y

- YE breed of the cow's tail, ye grow backward
 830 YE breed of foul weather, ye come unsent for
 Ye're breed of the chapman, ye're aye to handsell
 Ye breed of few of the laird's tenants, o'er her
 Ye breed of gude mawt, ye're lang a coming
 Ye crack crouselly wi' your bonnet on
 835 Ye cut before the point
 Ye cam a day after the fair
 Ye cut lang whangs out o' ither fowks leather
 Ye canna make a silk purse of a sow's lug
 840 Ye canna see the wood for trees
 Ye can never fare well but ye cry roast meat
 Ye come a clipping time
 Ye canna preach out of your poupit
 Ye come to the gait's house to thigg woo
 845 Ye canna do but ye o'er-do
 Ye drive the pleugh before the owfen
 Ye dinna ken where the blessing may light
 Ye drew nae fae well when my mare was in the mir
 Ye fand it where the Hig'landman fand the tangs

3 Ye glaw'r'd at the moon, and fell on the midding
 Ye glaw'r like a wild cat out of a whin bush
 Ye go far about seeking the nearest
 Ye have run lang on little ground
 Ye have a ready mouth for a ripe cherry
 13 Ye have ower foul feet to come sae far ben
 Ye have gotten a ravel'd help o't
 Ye have a clap for a corn
 Ye have ta'en the measure of his foot
 Ye have ower meikle loose leather about your chafte
 30 Ye have tint your ain stomach and funt a tike's
 Ye have put a toom spoon in my mouth
 Ye have fasted long and worried on a midge
 Ye have nothing to do but suck and wag your tail
 Ye have tint the tongue of the trumpet
 65 Ye have staid lang and brought little wi' you
 Ye have tap'e't upon you as the wife did the dancin
 Ye have the wrang sow by the lug
 Ye ken what drinkers dree
 Ye kepna wat may cool your ain kail yet
 70 Ye live at the lug of the law
 Ye'll either dance nor haud the candle
 Ye'll get nae mair of the cat but the skin
 Ye'll no sell your hen in a rainy day
 Ye'll ne'er cast saut on his tail
 375 Ye'll no herry yoursel with your ain hands
 Ye look liker a thief than a bishop
 Ye'll let little gae by you unless it be the swallow
 Ye may gang farther and fare ware
 Ye may get war bodies or Beitau
 380 Ye may be heard where ye're no seen
 Ye may dight your neb and fly up
 Ye may tak the will for the deed
 Ye mete my pease by your ain eck
 Ye'll never die on your ain affize
 385 Ye'll drink before me
 Ye'll find him where ye left him
 Ye may take the head for the washing
 Ye'll get the cat wi' the twa tails
 Ye'll beguile nane but them that lippens to you
 390 Ye'll mend when ye grow better
 Ye'll never be sae auld with sae mickle honesty

- Ye never saw green cheese but your een reek'd
 Ye never cost the cat's fault yet
 Ye're as daft as ye're day's auld
 895 Ye're a good seeker but an ill finder
 Ye're nae chicken for a' your cheeping
 Ye're like Mackay's mare ye brake fairly aff
 Ye're good enough but ye're no braw enough
 Ye're no sae poor as ye peep
 900 Ye're well away if ye bide, and we're well qu
 Ye're of fow many minds ye'll never be married
 Ye're never pleas'd fu' nor fasting
 Ye're unco good and ye'll grow fair
 Ye're sair fash'd hadding naething together
 905 Ye're no fed on deaf nuts
 Ye're sick but no sair handled
 Ye're busy seeking the thing that's no tint
 Ye're like the hens ye rin aye to the heap
 Ye're fear'd for the day ye never saw
 910 Ye're best when ye're sleeping
 Ye're a sweet nut if you were well cracked
 Ye're no light where ye lean a'
 Ye're Davy do naething, and good at naething
 Ye're come aff the house of Harlettilhim
 915 Ye're het yet and your belt's hale
 Ye soon weary of well doing
 Ye'se get your brose out of the lee side of the
 Ye shape shoon by your ain shackled feet
 Your tongue's nae slander
 920 Your tongue rin's aye before your wit
 Ye wad make mickle of me if I were yours
 Ye watna where a blessing may light
 Ye was never born at that time of the year
 Young folk may die, but auld folk maun die
 925 Young duck's may be auld geese
 Your meal's a deagh
 Your head will never fill your father's bonnet
 Your thrift's as good as the profit of a yell h
 Your wame thinks your wyfen's cutted
 930 Your purse was fleeked when that was paid for
 Your gear will never o'er gang you
 Your mienies milk is no out of your nose yet

FINIS



